Exemplar: The A-Grade Kill — Team Klausurly (M07 to Demo Day)

Updated: 2026-10-20.

Synthetic exemplar — realistic but invented. This is the artifact the rubric means by "a rigorously argued kill can be an A." Read it even if you never kill.

One-page autopsy, the Kill Ritual (week 8)

What we believed (Module 02). Students will pay for AI-generated practice exams in their professor's exact style.

1. What the evidence said

We tested in order. 14 Mom Test interviews (Module 03), then a landing page against a line of 10% of segment visitors (the course default since Module 04), which got 13.4% (Module 04). Then click dummies (Module 05) and a live prototype with 41 users and strong exam-week usage (Module 06). Then **the wallet. €4.99 per exam, and 0 of 9 paid** (Module 07 week). Our B2B pivot test asked 10 named tutoring schools in 5 days and got 2 replies and no interest ("we ARE the content").

Cause of death is free-alternative gravity. The pain is real, but free substitutes absorb all of it (forums, Moodle, ChatGPT).

2. Which line it crossed

“At least 3 buyers in the first 10 live asks”, written in our Kill Criteria Log before the first ask. We got 0 of 9. The B2B test had its own line, written before the first school was asked, and missed it too. **KILLED 16.05, announced in check-in.**

3. What surprised us

Usage-love is not willingness to pay. Our own glossary called it, 41 fans and 0 customers. And the Fachschaft channel that brought our visitors (12.9% CTR) was the strongest asset we had, stronger than the product.

4. What we’d tell the next founder

Ask “have you ever paid anything for this?” in week 2. We had the answer, 2 of 14, in our own Interview Log and didn’t weight it. It cost us 6 weeks.

The Restart Ramp (same week)

Kill Ritual done (this page). 48h re-ideation from OUR artifacts, starting from the surprise, the Fachschaft channel. **Concierge restart:** “Klausur-Countdown”, a paid, human-curated 4-week exam-prep sprint for Statik (the exam with the loudest panic quotes), €29, capped at 30 seats, sold through the same channel.

Outcome by Demo Day

23 seats sold × €29 = **€667 verified** (Stripe dashboard, zero social-graph buyers — Fachschaft channel is outside the rubric’s exclusion) · 19 of 23 completed · 11 said they’d buy the next one · second cohort waitlist: 31.

Why this is an A trajectory (grading rationale)

Evidence quality: every claim above cites an artifact (logs, thresholds, dashboards). Decision discipline: two pre-committed thresholds honored AGAINST the team’s attachment; kill announced publicly; no zombie weeks. Verified traction: €667 real revenue post-restart — less money than the top teams, more decision quality than almost anyone. Communication: this page IS the demo-day story.

The lesson to steal: the kill wasn’t the end of the company — it was the moment the team stopped spending weeks on a dead hypothesis and started charging for a live one.